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Full-stack software development

Front-end advanced: Client-side storage

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Browser storage

- A mechanism to store client-side data instead of only relying on server-side storage.
- Store data that is **safe** to store client-side and that can be used across your entire React application with all its components.
 - **Not passwords!**
- Two types: **local** storage and **session** storage.
- Prefer session storage: data is erased when the session ends.

Browser storage: reminder

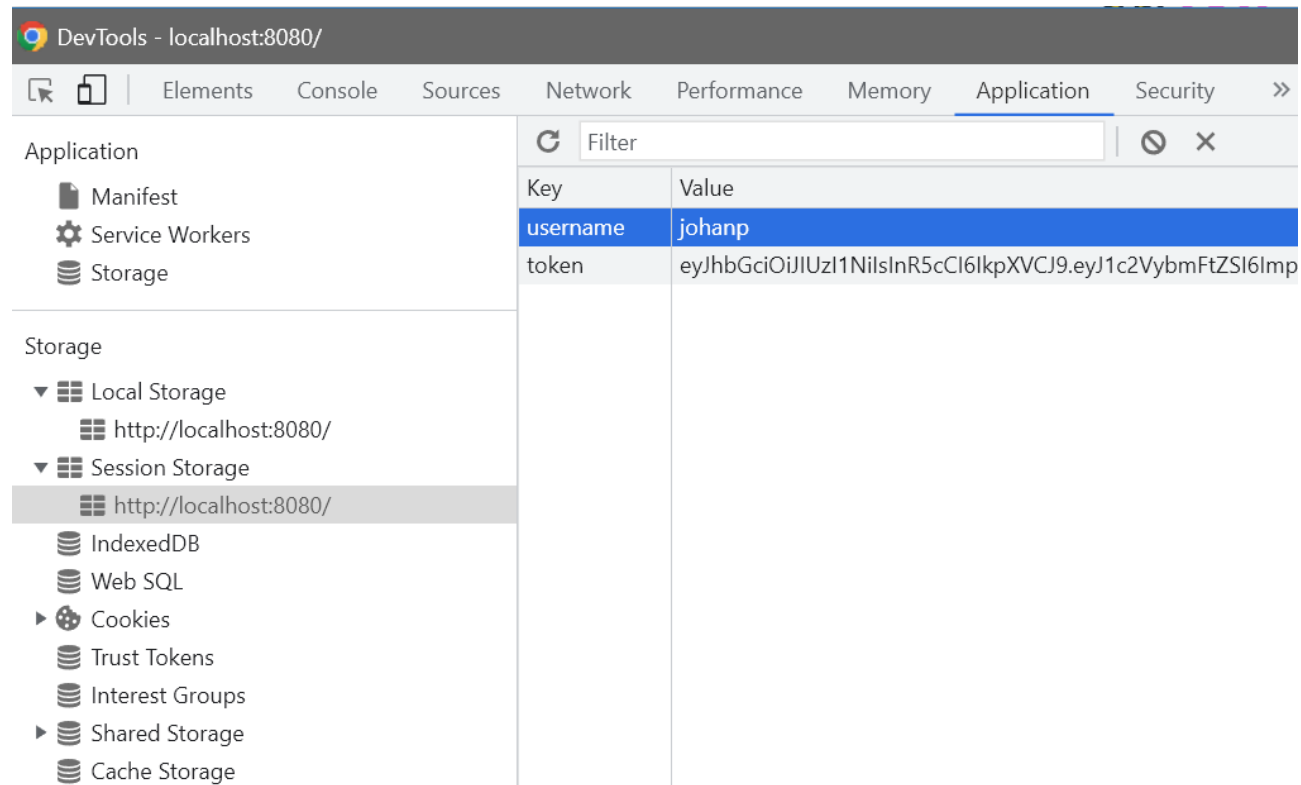
- Server components don't have access to browser APIs.
- Accessing browser storage is a browser API.
- You can only interact with browser storage in client components.

Browser storage: mutating

- Adding an entry: `sessionStorage.setItem("username", name);`
- Reading an entry: `setUsername(sessionStorage.getItem("username"));`
- Deleting an entry: `sessionStorage.removeItem("username");`

Browser storage: inspecting

- To see what is currently saved in storage you can use the developer tools of your browser:



Browser storage: what about cookies?

- Cookies are also a mechanism to store client-side data.
- You can use them to store small pieces of data and not just single values (eg preferences)
- In contrast to browser storage: cookies are sent back and forth to the server **with every request**: network performance impact.
- Cookies can have a custom expiration time.
- Cookies can be subject to **security and privacy concerns**: eg cross-site scripting, session hijacking, tracking, theft,...
 - You can secure cookies with HttpOnly, SameSite,... We will come back to this later in the course